

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

Phase 4 – Project Planning Phase

Project Documentation

4. Project Planning Phase

The Planning Phase defines the execution roadmap, milestones, business scenario, test scenario, testing strategy, and deployment validation plan.

4.1 Execution Roadmap

Stage	Milestone	Major Activity
Planning	Milestone 1	Service, Service Offering and CI setup
Development	Milestone 2	Incident Record Creation
Development	Milestone 3	Incident Classification
Development	Milestone 4	Knowledge Integration
Development	Milestone 5	Reassignment & Escalation
Development	Milestone 6	Level 2 Investigation
Development	Milestone 7	Emergency Change Creation
Development	Milestone 8	Child Incident Creation
Development	Milestone 9	Incident Resolution
Development	Milestone 10	Knowledge Creation
Validation	Final	SLA and Related Record Validation

4.2 Business/Test Scenario

A user is unable to connect to the Corporate VPN from home.

Field	Scenario Value
Short Description	Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office
Caller	Michael Hoefer
Channel	Phone
Category	Network
Subcategory	VPN
Urgency	2 - Medium
Service	Remote Access
Service Offering	Corporate VPN
Configuration Item	VPN Gateway
Initial Assignment	Service Desk
Escalation	Network team
Level 2 Finding	VPN-SRV-02 requires a restart
Change	Emergency Change Request to restart VPN-SRV-02
Resolution	VPN service restarted and incident resolved
Knowledge	Resolution converted into a Knowledge Article

4.3 Testing Strategy

Incident creation

Field classification

Assignment

Knowledge search

Knowledge article attachment

Reassignment

Level 2 investigation

SLA visibility

Change creation

Change linkage

Child incident creation

Resolution

Knowledge creation

Related records

4.4 Deployment Validation Plan

Confirm parent incident is resolved.

Confirm child incident is resolved.

Confirm Change Request is linked.

Confirm Knowledge Article is created.

Confirm resolution and cause are documented.

Confirm SLA is visible.

Confirm Related Records are available.

Confirm Activity Log contains the expected lifecycle history.

4.5 Deliverables

Configured ServiceNow records and workflow

Incident lifecycle implementation

Emergency Change Request relationship

Parent-child incident relationship

Knowledge Article

Validation evidence

Final project documentation

4.6 Conclusion

The Planning Phase organizes the implementation into controlled milestones and defines how the completed workflow will be tested and validated.